



NORTHERN VIRGINIA

BUYER HANDBOOK

A data-driven guide to buying your Northern Virginia home with confidence



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WELCOME & OVERVIEW

WELCOME TO YOUR HOME BUYING JOURNEY

Buying a home is one of the biggest financial decisions you will make. My job is to make it a clear one. I combine market data with local knowledge of Northern Virginia, so every decision, from your budget to your final offer, is backed by numbers instead of guesswork. Keep this handbook close, and call me whenever a question comes up.

WHY OWN A HOME

- Build equity with every payment
- Lock in a predictable fixed-rate payment
- Possible deductions for mortgage interest
- Freedom to make the home your own

WHAT'S INSIDE

- Financial Preparation
- Finding the Right Property
- The Buying Process
- After Purchase & Final Tips

Consult a tax professional about your situation.



FINANCIAL PREPARATION

KNOW YOUR NUMBERS BEFORE YOU TOUR

Your budget is your monthly payment, not the list price. Keep housing costs at or below 28% of gross monthly income and all debts at or below 36%. FHA loans start at 3.5% down, and VA loans at 0% for eligible veterans. Budget 2% to 5% for closing costs, and get preapproved before you tour.

YOUR CHECKLIST:

GET PREAPPROVED

PLAN DOWN PAYMENT

CLOSING COSTS

GUARD YOUR CREDIT



FINDING THE RIGHT PROPERTY

DEFINE YOUR NEEDS VS WANTS

Finding the right home is often the hardest part of buying. Start with why you are moving, then decide where you want to live and what the home must have. When a tough compromise comes up, return to your why. Every home we seriously consider gets a comparable sales review before we talk price.

MUST-HAVES

- Commute & location
- Bedrooms & baths
- Budget range

WISH LIST

- Finished basement
- Walkable area
- Garage or yard



THE BUYING PROCESS

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS



Consultation

Set goals, sign buyer agreement



Preapproval

Know your budget before tours



Tour Homes

View homes that fit your needs



Make an Offer

Price and terms backed by data



Inspection & Appraisal

Confirm condition and value



Settlement

Sign documents, get your keys

IMPORTANT DOCUMENTS

- > Photo ID
- > Pay stubs
- > Tax returns
- > Bank statements

OFFER TIPS

- > Lead with comps
- > Strong deposit
- > Flexible settlement
- > Be ready to walk away



AFTER PURCHASE & FINAL TIPS

CONGRATULATIONS! NOW IT'S TIME TO SETTLE IN.

Getting your keys is the start of ownership, not the end of our work together. Keep your settlement statement and deed with your tax records, and set aside about 1% of your home's value each year for upkeep. I am always a call away for a free home value update or advice on your next move.

NEXT STEPS:

- Change locks and codes
- Transfer utilities
- Update your DMV address
- Keep all documents safe



Real estate isn't just about properties. It's about people making informed decisions with confidence.

– Christopher Ryan



LET'S FIND YOUR HOME

BOOK YOUR BUYER CONSULTATION

In one conversation, we will map out your budget, your ideal neighborhoods, and a clear plan to get your keys. No pressure, just straight answers backed by Northern Virginia market data. Scan the code or call me to pick a time that works for you.

REACH ME DIRECTLY

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SCAN TO BOOK



Select a 30 minute block for a 1 on 1 consultation.

